



OPERATIONS PLAYBOOK · INTERNAL

Investor Execution Platform: From Lead Magnet to Close

The end-to-end build: funnel architecture, nurture, offer stack, ads, refund mechanics, and KPIs.

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NC General Contractor License #107724
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HOW TO READ THIS

The platform, end to end

This playbook is the operating system for the Southern Cities Construction investor funnel. It documents every stage from the first cold-ad impression to the final invoice on a CO5 full-GC build. It is the single source of truth for: what each product sells, what it costs, what its refund mechanic is, how leads move between stages, and what KPIs trigger the next bet.

Positioning anchor

Southern Cities Construction is an execution-intelligence platform for NC real estate investors.

We do not lead with construction services. We lead with the question: *can this deal actually be executed at the budget you ran?* Construction is the back-end. Intelligence is the wedge.

Three guarantee buckets

DIAGNOSIS · find the problem

LM1 (9-Risk PDF) and CO1 (Execution Review). We promise to find specific dollarized risks. If we cannot produce a decision-grade output we refund — SCC controls the trigger.

PERFORMANCE · solve the problem

CO2, CO3, CO4. We promise specific execution outcomes — scope locked, subs vetted, draws documented, risk eliminated on a per-deal basis. Refund if we cannot perform our scope.

DELIVERY · solve it well

CO5 Full GC. We promise quality, schedule, and accountability under a full GC contract — the standard NC GC delivery promise, backed by the license.

THE FUNNEL

Lead magnet to close, in one diagram

Every paid dollar enters at the top and exits at one of five rungs. The 9-Risk PDF is the entry. CO1 is the router. CO2 through CO5 are the destinations.

STAGE	NAME	WHAT IT DOES
TOP	Meta Ads (cold)	\$60/day starting budget. 6 ad variants. Goal: drive PDF downloads.
LM1	9-Risk PDF (free)	Email capture. Branded PDF, 9 dollarized risks, \$60K–\$119.5K exposure callout.
NURTURE	7-Email Sequence	Day 0 → Day 28. Origin story, anti-guru framing, CO1 offer, soft + hard closes.
CO1	Investor Execution Review · \$499	Live walk of a real deal. Routes to CO2/CO3/CO4/CO5 based on type.
CO2	Project Setup	Scope + sub-vetting + draw schedule. Investor stays GC of record.
CO3	Active Project Oversight	Tiered \$6.5K–\$28.5K. We oversee, investor still owns.
CO4	GC-Supported Owner Build	\$5K + 4% of budget. Owner-builder structure, SCC backs the license-level risk.
CO5	Full GC	% of project budget. Standard full GC contract under our license.

Why CO1 is the router, not just a rung

Most platforms try to sell the biggest product first. We deliberately do the opposite. The \$499 Execution Review qualifies the investor (real deal + real capital + real timeline), lets us see the property type, and routes them to the right downstream product. A flipper with a \$120K rehab budget routes to CO3. A wholesaler with no construction appetite routes to CO4. A capital-rich owner-builder with a clean lot routes to CO5. CO1 is the diagnostic that earns the right to recommend.

STAGE · LM1

Lead Magnet — The 9-Risk PDF

PRICE

\$0 · free

PROMISE

Deliver a decision-grade rehab budget range, timeline, project category, and execution risk snapshot for any NC deal — a contractor-grade underwriting foundation, before one missed risk becomes ten.

AUDIENCE

Active NC investors (flippers, wholesalers, BRRRR), capital-light and capital-rich. The hook is 'keep \$10K+ in your pocket on your next deal.'

DELIVERABLES

- 9 dollarized execution risks specific to NC investor deals in 2026
- Total exposure callout: \$60K–\$119.5K per deal
- Anti-guru founder story (Darius lost \$100K+ early on)
- Two-path CTA: hand off the deal or learn how SCC underwrites it
- Branded PDF, 12 pages, navy/orange palette, NC GC License #107724 on every page

REFUND MECHANIC

Free — no refund mechanic. The cost is one email address.

KPIs / TRIGGER TO ADVANCE

Goal: 80–100 PDF downloads in first 14 days at < \$15 CPL. Advance to Phase 2 retargeting once hit.

THE 7-EMAIL NURTURE

Day 0 to Day 28 — PDF download to CO1 purchase

The PDF earns the email. The nurture earns the \$499. Every email has one job: move the lead one step closer to clicking the CO1 checkout. No email pitches CO2-CO5. CO1 is the only purchase decision until the lead is on a call.

DAY	EMAIL	JOB
Day 0	PDF Delivery + Hello	Deliver the PDF. Introduce Darius. State the origin: '\$100K lost in my first 8 years.'
Day 2	The \$100K Lesson	Specific story of a deal that lost money on execution. Tease CO1 as the antidote.
Day 5	Why Most GCs Won't	The moat: most GCs won't review a deal you don't own yet. Open CO1 link.
Day 10	Risk #7 Deep Dive	Pick one risk from the PDF, go deeper, show what the CO1 review would catch.
Day 16	Soft CO1 Pitch	Reframe: \$499 vs. the \$14K average miss. Math first. Refund mechanic disclosed.
Day 22	Hard CO1 Pitch	Direct ask. Deadline-anchored (next-deal window). Single CTA: book the review.
Day 28	Final / Long Tail	Last email. Reframe as 'I'll be here when you have the deal.' Tag for long-tail nurture.

GHL implementation notes

Trigger tag: **lead-magnet-nc-execution-risks-investor**. Stop tags: **purchased-platform-co1-execution-review, platform-co2-purchased, platform-co3-purchased, platform-co4-purchased, platform-co5-purchased**. All emails are written and live in *docs/platform/pdf-lead-to-co1-nurture-sequence.md*. Copy/paste into GHL workflow builder; do not rewrite — the tone is calibrated.

STAGE · CO1

Investor Execution Review

PRICE

\$499 · one-time

PROMISE

Eliminate \$5,000+ of execution risk on your next deal — or confirm the deal is clean and let you move forward with documentation that protects your downside.

AUDIENCE

Investors with a specific deal under contract (or about to be) who want a licensed GC to underwrite the execution side before earnest money goes hard.

DELIVERABLES

- 60-minute live deal walkthrough (Zoom or in-person where geography permits)
- Written execution-risk report with dollarized findings
- Sub-trade list with line-item budget ranges
- Recommended downstream path: CO2 / CO3 / CO4 / CO5
- Right of first refusal on whichever downstream product is recommended

REFUND MECHANIC

Refund if SCC cannot produce a written risk report within 7 days of the call. SCC controls the trigger.

KPIs / TRIGGER TO ADVANCE

Goal: 2% nurture conversion. 35% of CO1 buyers should advance to CO2-CO5 within 90 days.

STAGE · CO2

Project Setup

PRICE

Scoped per project

PROMISE

Build the execution backbone of the deal — full scope, sub list, draw schedule, and permit strategy — so the investor or their existing GC can run a deal that doesn't fall apart at draw 3.

AUDIENCE

Investors who want to remain GC of record (or self-perform) but lack the scope/sub/draw infrastructure to do it without leaking money.

DELIVERABLES

- Full written scope of work (room-by-room, finish-by-finish)
- Vetted sub list with 2-3 quotes per trade
- Bank-grade draw schedule
- Permit + inspection roadmap
- Handoff call to align investor + lender + subs

REFUND MECHANIC

Refund of setup fee if scope + sub list + draw schedule are not delivered within the agreed window.

KPIs / TRIGGER TO ADVANCE

Goal: 60% of CO2 buyers should also retain SCC for CO3 oversight on the same project.

STAGE · CO3

Active Project Oversight

PRICE

\$6.5K · \$12.5K · \$19.5K · \$28.5K (tiered, scoped)**PROMISE**

Run the active oversight layer of your project — site visits, draw releases, sub management, schedule defense — without you having to be on-site or fielding sub calls.

AUDIENCE

Investors who own the deal but don't want to be the project manager. Tiered by project size / complexity: Light (\$6.5K), Standard (\$12.5K), Heavy (\$19.5K), Complex (\$28.5K).

DELIVERABLES

- Weekly on-site walks with photo + video documentation
- Draw release approvals (lender-ready)
- Sub management — calls, change orders, schedule defense
- Issue escalation in writing, within 24 hours
- Final punch-list closeout + lender turnover docs

REFUND MECHANIC

Refund of unearned portion if SCC withdraws from active oversight before project completion.

KPIs / TRIGGER TO ADVANCE

Goal: 25% of CO3 clients return for a second project within 12 months.

STAGE · CO4

GC-Supported Owner Build

PRICE

\$5,000 + 4% of project budget

PROMISE

Stand up the owner-builder structure so you (the investor) hold the GC-of-record position legally, while SCC backs the license-level risk, paperwork, and inspector-facing accountability.

AUDIENCE

Capital-rich investors who want to own the deal at the GC level — keeping the full spread — without taking on the personal license exposure of being unlicensed GC of record.

DELIVERABLES

- Owner-builder filing + permit pull under owner-builder framework
- Inspector-facing point-of-contact (SCC handles all inspections)
- License-level risk umbrella (we stand behind the license, not the labor)
- Weekly check-in calls
- Final closeout + certificate-of-occupancy paperwork

REFUND MECHANIC

Refund of \$5K upfront if SCC cannot stand up the owner-builder structure within 30 days.

KPIs / TRIGGER TO ADVANCE

Goal: 10% of CO4 clients advance to CO5 on their second project (they get tired of owning the seat).

STAGE · CO5

Full GC

PRICE

% of project budget · standard NC GC contract

PROMISE

Full general contractor engagement — SCC owns the license, the schedule, the subs, the budget, and the delivery. Investor underwrites the deal and approves milestones; SCC runs the build.

AUDIENCE

Investors who don't want to touch construction at all — capital-rich, time-poor, or out-of-state. Also returning CO3/CO4 clients who decide they'd rather hand it all over.

DELIVERABLES

- Full GC contract under NC GC License #107724
- Fixed-budget or cost-plus structure (negotiated per project)
- Schedule + milestone reporting
- All subs, materials, permits, inspections under SCC
- Standard NC GC warranty + closeout

REFUND MECHANIC

Standard NC GC contract — refund mechanic per contract milestones, governed by NC law.

KPIs / TRIGGER TO ADVANCE

Goal: this is the LTV peak. One CO5 client = 6+ months of ad spend paid back.

AD CREATIVE

Six variants, one target audience

All six variants target active NC investors — flippers, wholesalers, BRRRR operators. Each variant attacks a different pain. Rotate three at a time in \$20/day cells. Kill any cell over \$25 CPL at Day 3. Scale the winner at Day 7.

VARIANT	HOOK	AUDIENCE
#1	Stop Being the GC	Flippers running jobs themselves; bottlenecked at 2 deals/year.
#2A	Wholesaler Two Paths	NC wholesalers losing deals at the buyer's lender due to execution risk.
#2B	Stop the \$50K Giveaway	Wholesalers leaving full-flip spread on the table — convert to investor.
#3	Scale BRRRR to 8/Year	BRRRR operators capped by bad rehabs; killing cash-out refis.
#4	Find. Hand Off. Collect.	Generalist investors who want the cleanest possible value prop.
#5	Flip the 60/40 Ratio	Investors spending 60% of their time on execution, 40% on deals.

Meta targeting

Geographic: NC statewide. **Age:** 28–55. **Interests:** BiggerPockets, DealMachine, PropStream, Privy, Carrot, REI Pro, Roofstock, REtipster, Pace Morby, Brent Daniels. **Behaviors:** small business owners, real estate professionals, recent home buyers. **Lookalikes:** seed with PDF downloaders once 200+ leads acquired; refresh every 30 days.

Launch sequence

Phase 1 (Days 1–14): Lead magnet only, \$60/day, rotate #1 / #2B / #4. Target CPL < \$15. **Phase 2 (Days 15–30):** Add a \$20/day retargeting cell — show CO1 direct to PDF-downloaders who opened the nurture 2+ times. **Phase 3 (Day 30+):** Only after Meta pixel has 50+ CO1 purchases, test cold-direct-to-CO1 ads against lookalikes of paid buyers.

KPIs & BENCHMARKS

What 'working' looks like — by phase

If you don't hit the Phase 1 numbers, do not scale. If you do, scale aggressively. The whole funnel is gated by lead cost and CO1 conversion rate; everything downstream (CO2-CO5) is a function of those two numbers.

METRIC	TARGET	DEFINITION
CPL (cost per lead)	<\$15	PDF download + email capture
Lead → CO1 buyer	2.0%	Nurture conversion rate over 30 days
CO1 → CO2/3/4/5	35%	Of CO1 buyers who book a CO1, this % progresses
Average deal value (downstream)	\$11.5K	Weighted across CO2-CO5
LTV per lead	\$85	CPL × conversion × avg ticket
Target CAC payback	<60 days	Days from ad spend to net-positive

Stop / Scale rules

STOP

If CPL > \$25 after Day 3 of a cell, kill the cell. If lead → CO1 < 0.8% after 100 leads, rebuild the nurture. If CO1 → CO2-5 < 15%, the CO1 walk-through is failing to route — rebuild the CO1 deliverable, not the nurture.

SCALE

If CPL < \$12 and lead → CO1 > 2.5% over a 14-day window, double the daily budget. If a single CO1 buyer routes to CO5, that one customer pays back ~6 months of ad spend at \$60/day.

REFUND MECHANICS

Promise structure across every paid stage

Every paid stage has a refund mechanic. The mechanic is always controlled by SCC — never by an outcome the buyer can manipulate (e.g., 'I didn't make the projected ROI'). We refund when WE cannot perform our deliverable. This is the 'refund if we cannot perform' model.

STAGE	PRICE	REFUND TRIGGER
LM1 · 9-Risk PDF	FREE	No refund — no charge. Built for top-of-funnel education.
CO1 · Execution Review	\$499	Refund if we cannot produce a written risk report within 7 days of the call.
CO2 · Project Setup	Scoped	Refund of setup fee if scope + sub list + draw schedule isn't delivered in agreed window.
CO3 · Project Oversight	\$6.5K–\$28.5 K	Refund of unearned portion if SCC withdraws from active oversight.
CO4 · Owner Build Support	\$5K + 4%	Refund of upfront if SCC cannot stand up the owner-builder structure within 30 days.
CO5 · Full GC	% of budget	Standard NC GC contract — refund mechanic per contract milestones.

Why this model wins

Outcome-based guarantees (e.g., '\$10K saved or your money back') invite gaming and adverse selection — the buyer is incentivized to under-cooperate to trigger the refund. Performance-based guarantees ('refund if WE cannot perform') keep the trigger on our side, which forces us to be honest about what we can deliver, and protects margin. Buyers still get the psychological safety of 'risk-reversal' without creating moral-hazard incentives.

WHAT TO DO THIS WEEK

The 7-day action list

#	TASK	DETAILS
1	Save ad variants to disk	Lock the 6 variants in docs/marketing/active-investor-execution-handoff-ads.md
2	Build 7-email nurture in GHL	Paste from pdf-lead-to-co1-nurture-sequence.md into GHL workflow
3	Configure GHL trigger tag	Confirm lead-magnet-nc-execution-risks-investor fires on PDF download
4	Launch Phase 1 Meta ads	\$60/day, rotate #1 / #2B / #4, \$20/day each, NC statewide
5	Wire CO1 checkout test	End-to-end test: PDF → email → nurture link → CO1 Stripe checkout
6	Set Day-3 review	Calendar reminder. Kill cells over \$25 CPL. Keep budget on winner.
7	Set Day-14 phase gate	If CPL < \$15 and 80+ leads: advance to Phase 2 retargeting.

The platform compounds. The ads don't.

Every PDF download is an asset. Every CO1 buyer routes downstream. Every CO3/CO4/CO5 client is a 6–12 month revenue tail. Ads are the input — the platform is the output. Build the platform; measure the platform; scale the platform.

Darius T. Walton · Southern Cities Construction · NC GC License #107724 · 2026